

Distance metrics encode different biological contrasts

Choose the signal before inspecting group separation

Bray-Curtis	YES	—	—	—
Jaccard	—	YES	—	—
Unweighted UniFrac	—	YES	YES	—
Weighted UniFrac	YES	—	YES	—
Aitchison	YES	—	—	YES
Robust Aitchison	YES	—	—	YES
	Abundance	Occurrence	Phylogeny	Log-ratio
Information used by the metric				

Occurrence and UniFrac branches use 50,000 reads per sample.
Aitchison branches use filtered unrarefied counts; classic CLR uses a declared pseudocount.